You don't need a role model, you need a warning.

Channel: Greg Lav · Published: Oct 14, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/8UJC2V2FdG4 Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

When defining your goals feels impossible, flip the approach: identify what you *don't* want. Studying people you don't want to become helps you reverse-engineer the traits, habits, and values you actually do want.

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🎯 The Problem: Most People Can't Define What They Want 0:00

- Articulating your goals is extremely difficult — even explaining them to others is hard
- Most people cannot clearly identify what they want out of life
  - The speaker admits he still struggles with this himself
- Without knowing what you want, reaching any meaningful end goal becomes nearly impossible

🔄 The Inversion Strategy: Use "Warning" People as a Compass 0:21

- The easier alternative: define what you *don't* want
  - It is simpler to look at people around you and identify who you do *not* want to become
  - These people serve as "warnings" rather than role models
- The speaker's personal experience:
  - At a low point in his life — describing himself as "a man of no value in society" — he had no one around he wanted to emulate
  - He *was* surrounded by people whose path he wanted to avoid
  - Rather than seeing this as purely negative, he used it as actionable information

> "It's easier to look around and draw inspiration from the people you *don't* want to be like than from those you do."

✍️ The First Step: Writing It All Down 0:21

- He began writing down the specific traits, actions, and habits of the people he did *not* want to resemble
  - This concrete journaling exercise made the abstract feel tangible
- The byproduct: by clearly listing what he *didn't* want, the qualities he *did* want began to emerge naturally
  - Negatives revealed their positive opposites
- **This is framed as the foundational first step** to shaping your life and clarifying your true desires
  - Practical takeaway: grab a notebook and list the traits, behaviors, and outcomes you actively want to avoid — your real goals will start to surface from that list